It has been over four months that the global community had been fighting against the Coronavirus. Forty-two lakh people across the world have been infected and tragically over 2.75 lakh have lost their lives. In India too, people have lost near and dear ones. And I express my heartfelt condolences to all. The virus has destroyed the world with crores of people facing the crisis. Across the world, countries are engaged in a battle to save precious lives. We have never seen or even heard of a crisis of such proportion. It a crisis which is unthinkable and unprecedented for all mankind.

Lekin, thaknaa, harna, tootna, bikharna manav ko manzoor nahi hai. Satark rehte hue, aisi jung ke sabhi niyamo ka palan karte hue, ab hume bachna bhi hai aur aage badhna bhi hai. (But, getting tired, losing, and breaking down is not acceptable to mankind. By being vigilant and following the new rules of the battle, we not only have to protect ourselves but also move forward.) Today, as the world is in crisis, we have to strengthen our resolve. It is this collective resolve which will be even more powerful than the crisis.

Hum pichli shataabdi se hi lagaatar sunte aaye hai ki eekisvi sadi Hindustan ki hai. (We have been hearing since the last century that the twenty-first century will belong to India.) We have had the opportunity to study and analyse in great detail, pre-corona world order and the global arrangements. Even after the Corona crisis has struck, we have been closely and constantly observing the changing global situation. If we look at both of these, from India's perspective, it becomes clear that our dream of the twenty-first century belonging to India doesn't just have to be a dream but also our collective responsibility. But how do we get there? Looking at the prevailing situation in the world today, it is clear that there is only one road to our dream: *Atmanirbhar Bharat* (self-reliant India).

We stand today, as a nation at a very important crossroads. A huge crisis like this has brought to us a warning, a message and an opportunity. Today, the definition of self-reliance has been revisited. The whole world is now looking at human-centric globalization versus the prevalent economy-centric globalization of the recent past. It is here that India's fundamental value of *Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam* (the world is our family) comes in as a ray of hope to the world.[3]